

Work from Home Policy

Document and Version History

#	Version	Release Date	Description of Change	Created/Modified by	Approved by
1	2.0	01-Oct-24	Initial	HR Team	Gayathri V

Purpose:

The purpose of the Work from Home policy is to establish guidelines and expectations for employees who work remotely, typically from their homes. The policy outlines the requirements and responsibilities of an employee and sets clear expectations for communication, productivity, security, and performance. Work-from-home arrangements can be occasional or temporary.

Eligibility

Employees under full-time employment are entitled to the work-from-home (WFH) option, except for the following:

1. WFH or hybrid work arrangements will not be applicable during critical business situations, including but not limited to:
 - a. Client escalations or emergencies.
 - b. Projects designated as "red" or high-risk.
 - c. Situations where critical deliverables are due and require close coordination.
 - d. Any other circumstance where in-office presence is deemed essential by management.

These exceptions take precedence, and employees must comply with the requirement to be physically present at the workplace as needed.

2. Employees currently in training/upskilling.
3. Employees with 0 to 1 year of experience are not eligible for work-from-home (WFH) or hybrid work arrangements. Employees with 1 to 2 years of experience are also not eligible for WFH or hybrid mode. However, employees who demonstrate exceptional

performance, as determined by management through performance evaluations, may be granted the privilege of WFH or hybrid eligibility on a case-by-case basis. This privilege will be subject to periodic review and may be revoked at any time based on changes in performance or business needs.

4. Senior leadership and due to the nature of their roles, are generally expected to work from the office to ensure effective collaboration, leadership, and support for their teams. While flexibility is valued, the responsibilities at these levels often require a physical presence to manage critical operations, make timely decisions, and provide on-site support when needed. This policy ensures that senior leaders can maintain close engagement with their teams and uphold the operational standards necessary for successful project delivery.
5. Support team members are typically required to work from the office to ensure effective guidance and on-site support. While flexibility is appreciated, their roles often demand a physical presence to maintain smooth operations and provide timely assistance.

WFH Days

1. **Mandatory WFH Day:** Each project team is allowed to work from home for two days per week, totaling up to eight days per month. The Project Manager will determine this day based on project requirements and team dynamics. This cannot be carried forward to the following week or month.
2. Any additional WFH days beyond the allowed eight per month will be deducted from the employee's Casual Leave (CL), Privilege Leave (PL), or treated as Leave Without Pay (LOP) if no leave balance is available.
3. If an employee decides to work from the office on their designated work-from-home days, these days cannot be compensated or exchanged for additional time off.

Criteria for WFH Approval

1. **Work Schedule:** Employees must adhere to their regular work hours and be available during core hours.
2. **Communication/Availability:** Employees must be reachable via email, phone, and instant messaging during working hours.
3. **Productivity:** Employees are expected to maintain the same level of productivity and meet all deadlines as if they were working in the office.
4. **Workspace:** Employees must ensure a suitable and secure workspace at home, free from distractions and with a reliable internet connection.

Responsibilities

1. **Employee Responsibilities:**
 - Ensure they have access to the necessary tools and resources to perform their duties effectively.
 - Comply with all company policies and guidelines while working from home.
 - Report any technical issues immediately to the IT department.

2. Manager Responsibilities:

- Ensure fair and consistent application of the WFH policy.
- Monitor and evaluate the productivity of employees working from home.
- Provide support and resources to employees to facilitate effective remote work.

Communication

Employees working from home are expected to:

- Stay connected via phone, email, and other communication tools during normal working hours.
- Attend virtual meetings as required.
- Inform their managers if they face any issues that may hinder their ability to work remotely/on their availability.

Review and Compliance

- This policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure it meets the needs of both the company and its employees.
- Non-compliance with the WFH policy may result in revocation of WFH privileges and could lead to disciplinary action.

Data Security

Remote employees are expected to maintain the same level of data security as those working in the office. To keep up with the security standards, all team members must

- Lock confidential information whenever they're away from their desks/home offices and undertake other appropriate measures to ensure no unauthorized person can see it.
- Avoid sharing their work devices with family members or friends.
- Use strong passwords and change them regularly.

Note: Approval from both the Reporting Manager and HR is required for exceptional cases regarding working from home more than the prescribed days.

Project-Wise Work from Home Policy Update

We have implemented a **project-wise split for the Work from Home (WFH)** policy to ensure smooth operations and better alignment with project needs. The allocations have been finalized, and the **respective managers have been informed**.

Conclusion

The WFH policy is designed to offer flexibility while maintaining productivity and project deadlines. Cooperation and adherence to this policy will ensure its success and benefit both employees and the company.

Disclaimer :

The applicability, eligibility of the reward may be implemented and/or changed by Ideas2IT from time to time at the sole discretion of ideas2IT and such implemented and/or changed shall become applicable to the employees immediately, upon receipt of notice of the same.

FAQs:

1. What is the purpose of this revised WFH policy?

The purpose of the WFH policy is to establish guidelines and expectations for employees working remotely, ensuring clear communication, productivity, security, and performance.

2. Can the Mandatory WFH Day be carried forward to next week?

No, the weekly Mandatory WFH Day cannot be carried forward to the next week.

3. What is the Mandatory WFH Day?

Each project team has two mandatory WFH days per week, determined by the Project Manager based on project requirements

4. Can employees avail themselves of the week WFH in one stretch?

No, the weekly WFH days cannot be availed in one stretch. The policy stipulates that the mandatory WFH day is fixed.

5. Can I take care of personal tasks while working from home?

While minor personal tasks are understandable, employees are expected to maintain professional standards and ensure that work commitments take priority during working hours.

6. What is required for WFH more than the prescribed days?

Any additional work from home apart from the prescribed will be considered as CL/PL/LOP.